City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, May 13, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

Councilmember Kim will be participating remotely.

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:30 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-26 Amending the Capital Improvement Budgets in the Department of Public Works (PW) to move funds budgeted for the 2024 PW City 1% Sales Tax to the 2024 Grand Snelling Intersection Improvement Project.

Received and Filed

2 AO 26-27 Amending CDBG Project Budgets: To allocate $20,000 in additional funding for the Ramsey County Window Replacement 2025 contract and to return $20,783 to the Housing Real Estate Undesignated Fund.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Item 15 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

3 RES 26-684 Approving the City's cost of providing Demolition 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for June 9, 2026 and City Council public hearing for July 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2606C, Assessment No. 262005)

Adopted

4 RES 26-748 Approving the City's cost of providing Repair of Sanitary Sewer Service Line on Private Properties and setting date of City Council public hearing for June 13, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. SWRP2602, Assessment No. 263001)

Adopted

5 RES 26-649 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe Adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the Operative Plasterers and Cement Masons International Association, Local No. 633.

Laid over to May 20, 2026

6 RES 26-784 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe Adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the International Association of Sheet Metal, Air, Rail and Transportation Workers, Local 10.

Laid over to May 20, 2026

7 RES 26-696 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe Adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the United Association of Plumbers, Local 34.

Laid over to May 20, 2026

8 RES 26-759 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the North Central States Regional Council of Carpenters.

Laid over to May 20, 2026

9 RES 26-722 Authorizing the City to enter into an agreement with the Minnesota Department of Transportation (MnDOT) and Ramsey County for MnDOT's Trunk Highway 61 Project.

Adopted

10 RES 26-746 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to apply for up to $1,900,000 from the Early Childhood Facilities Grant Program for the Conway Recreation Center project.

Adopted

11 RES 26-747 Authorizing the City to enter an amendment to lease agreement 15905 with National Cooperative Leasing (NCL) to continue leasing 27 Nissan Leaf S, and 39 Nissan Leaf fit to remain in the Evie Carshare fleet for another 3 years.

Adopted

12 RES 26-768 Authorizing the proper City officials to accept a gift stipend from the Vera Institute of Justice for Assistant City Attorney Edmundo D. Lijo to attend the SAFE Network Annual Convening in Denver, Colorado on May 7-8, 2026.

Adopted

13 RES 26-771 Authorizing the City to enter into a Master Services Agreement with Yardstik, Inc. (which includes an indemnification clause) to provide the Department of Parks and Recreation (Department) with certain reports and investigation services.

Adopted

14 RES 26-777 Approving the Mayor’s appointment of Jazmin Glaser-Kelly, Antonio Montez, Andrew Escobedo, and Gabriel Salah-Pfieffer to the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Adopted

16 RES 26-728 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the Tri-Council (LIUNA Laborers, Local 563; General Drivers, Local 120; and Operating Engineers, Local 49) for a 2026 interim wage increase during their reorganization transition.

Adopted

17 RES 26-809 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Cedrick Baker to serve as Assistant Mayor.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

15 RES 26-791 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Melanie McMahon to serve as the City's Director of Planning and Economic Development.

Councilmembers Johnson and Bowie expressed a desire for a two-week layover.

Councilmember Yang spoke in support of approval, expressed a preference for a one-week layover but willingness for a two-week layover.

Councilmembers Coleman and Jost spoke in support of approval and against a layover.

Councilmember Kim spoke in support of approval and a willingness for a two week layover.

Council President Noecker spoke in support of approval and against a layover.

Bowie and Johnson expressed concerns about the appointment.

Johnson moved to lay over for two weeks.

Laid over to May 27, 2026

Yea: 4 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie and Councilmember Johnson

Nay: 3 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

18 RES 26-532 Approving adverse action against the Liquor On-Sale 100 Seats or Less, Liquor Outdoor Service Area (Patio), Liquor On-Sale Sunday & Gambling Location license (License ID #20160001981) held by A & M Bar and Grill LLC d/b/a St Paul Saloon for the premises located at 1045 Hudson Road and imposing the recommended presumptive matrix penalty and amended license conditions. (Licensee will speak to Council on their own behalf.)

Monica Shaffer from the City Attorney's Office gave a staff report.

Alex Rivero, license holder, spoke to council.

Council President Noecker asked if Rivero was contesting the facts.

Shaffer stated that she was told by the Department of Safety and Inspections (DSI) that the license holder was admitting to the facts and contesting the penalty.

Rivero continued his remarks.

Noecker stated that if facts were being contested, that Council was not equipped to examine evidence and that the matter should go before an administrative law judge (ALJ).

Noecker paused the item to continue with other business while Shaffer and Rivero discussed paths forward.

Item resumed after the Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda.

Shaffer stated that Rivero agreed that there was gunfire in the bar on the night in question, and that the security guard was not visibly identifiable. She added that he was challenging the monetary impacts that the conditions would have on his business. She then reviewed his options.

Rivero stated that he did not want to go before an ALJ and continued his remarks.

Rivero answered questions from Councilmember Johnson.

Shaffer answered questions from Johnson.

Johnson spoke in favor and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

19 Ord 26-25 Amending Chapter 66 of the Legislative Code to correct a scrivener's error related to allowing additional lot coverage for providing functional green roof space.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

20 Ord 26-26 Updating Chapter 310 of the Legislative Code (Title XXIX) pertaining to Uniform License Procedures to extend payment of license renewal fees owed in calendar year 2026.

Council President Noecker spoke in favor and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

21 RES PH 26-105 Approving the petition of the Department of Parks and Recreation, on behalf of the City of St. Paul, to vacate the public right-of-way, Morton Street, in Baker Playground.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 RES PH 26-110 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to accept additional grant funding in the amount of $43,745.00 from the State of Minnesota, Department of Natural Resources to support Saint Paul's tree planting program.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 RES PH 26-112 Approving the application of OSP Events LLC for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Lowertown Sounds event series on the Thursdays of June 4, 11, 18, 25, July 9, 16, 23, and 30, 2026, with the potential addition of Thursdays August 13 and 20, 2026, at 221 5th Street East - Mears Park.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

24 RES PH 26-116 Authorizing the Police Department to accept the donation from the Ramsey County Chiefs of Police Association which is designated for officer travel costs when representing the Police Department at the National Police Week in Washington D.C.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

25 RLH TA 26-80 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1216 ALBEMARLE STREET. (File No. 2603T, Assessment No. 269002)

Adopted

26 RLH SAO 26-41 Second Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 399 BLAIR AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-16. (Legislative Hearing May 12, 2026)

Public hearing continued to June 10, 2026

27 RLH SAO 26-18 Second Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 708 HAWTHORNE AVENUE EAST in Council File RLH SAO 26-8.

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated)

28 RLH VO 26-22 Appeal of Frank Andrew to a Fire Inspection Correction Notice (which includes condemnation) at 484 ROBERT STREET NORTH.

Adopted

29 RLH RR 26-5 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 299 SHERBURNE AVENUE within fifteen (15) days after the April 15, 2026, City Council Public Hearing. (Public hearing continued to May 13, 2026)

Adopted as amended (granted 180 days)

30 RLH SAO 26-36 Appeal of Victor Thao to a Summary Abatement Order at 685 VAN BUREN AVENUE.

Adopted

31 RLH SAO 26-40 Second Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 412 WHITE BEAR AVENUE NORTH in Council File RLH SAO 26-25.

Adopted

32 RLH AR 26-26 Ratifying the assessment for Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous Tree(s) service during Nov-Dec 2025 (File No. 2603T, Assessment No. 269002)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:27 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
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